

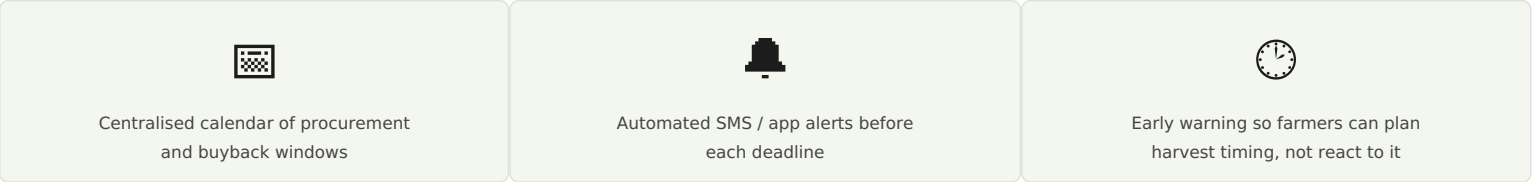
FARMIQ : Platform Report

Smart Procurement Scheduling for Farmers | Ending Missed Selling Windows | Field Insights



A. Executive Summary

FarmIQ is a smart automation platform that helps farmers stay ahead of procurement schedules — the dates and windows on which government mandis, cooperatives and bulk buyers are ready to collect or purchase produce. Today, this information reaches farmers late, incompletely, or not at all: through word of mouth, a local agent's tip-off, or a notice posted after the window has already opened. Farmers who miss a schedule are often forced into a distress sale at whatever price and buyer are available that day, or watch perishable produce lose value while they wait for the next opportunity. FarmIQ automates the tracking of these schedules and sends farmers timely, personalised alerts so they can plan harvest and sale around real dates instead of rumours. This report summarises the problem, how FarmIQ addresses it, and what still needs to be validated.



Concept illustration of the FarmIQ scheduling workflow — field photography pending pilot rollout.

B. Platform Snapshot

Zero MISSED WINDOWS Goal: no unnoticed deadline	Auto SCHEDULE ALERTS Sent ahead of each date	Multi SOURCE TRACKING Govt + mandi + private buyers	Plan AHEAD, NOT REACT Harvest timed to demand	Pilot STAGE PLATFORM In development / field testing
--	---	--	--	--

C. The Manual Way: Where the Farmer Loses Time

Procurement Window Opens	Word of Mouth / Delay	Local Agent Tips Off Late	Farmer Reacts Last-Minute	Window Missed / Distress Sale
--------------------------	-----------------------	---------------------------	---------------------------	-------------------------------

Every stage of manual, word-of-mouth tracking adds a delay. By the time news of a procurement window reaches a farmer informally, the best slot may already be filled or the deadline may have passed. The farmer either misses the window entirely or scrambles to sell in a hurry, usually on worse terms. FarmIQ replaces the middle three steps with a single automated path: **Schedule Published → Farmer Alerted → Farmer Plans Ahead.**

D. Why This Matters

Missed windows Without visibility into dates, farmers find out about a procurement window too late to prepare their produce.	Distress selling A missed schedule often forces a rushed sale to whoever is available, usually at a lower price than planning would have secured.	Spoilage & logistics chaos Perishable crops lose quality while farmers wait for the next unclear opportunity, and transport is arranged last-minute.
--	---	--

Objective of FarmIQ: to give every farmer a clear, automated view of upcoming procurement and buyback opportunities, so that harvest and sale decisions are planned in advance rather than made in a panic.

E. Problems Farmers Face Without Procurement Scheduling

1. No visibility into dates Government mandi and buyback schedules exist, but are scattered across notices, offices and informal channels farmers rarely see in time.	2. Last-minute notice News usually arrives through a local agent or neighbour, often only a day or two before — too late to plan the harvest around it.	3. Manual tracking Farmers rely on memory, paper notes or informal reminders, which are easy to lose track of across a busy season.	4. Distress sales A missed window forces a same-day sale to whichever buyer is available, regardless of price.
5. Spoilage risk Perishable produce loses quality and value while farmers wait for unclear or delayed procurement news.	6. No cross-buyer view Farmers cannot easily compare government, cooperative and private buyer schedules to choose the best option.	7. Repeated re-planning Schedule changes or postponements are not communicated back, so farmers keep preparing for dates that shift.	8. Dependence on agents Access to schedule information is filtered through the same agents who benefit from farmers acting on partial or late information.

→ Together, these gaps mean farmers lose selling opportunities and income not because demand is absent, but because they never found out about it in time.

F. Manual Tracking vs. FarmIQ

Area	Without FarmIQ	With FarmIQ
Schedule visibility	Scattered notices, word of mouth	Centralised calendar of all known procurement windows
Timing of information	Often arrives after the window opens	Automated alerts sent ahead of each deadline
Planning	Reactive; harvest not aligned to demand	Proactive; farmer plans harvest around confirmed dates
Buyer / scheme coverage	Usually limited to one local source	Tracks government, cooperative and private buyer schedules together
Changes & postponements	Rarely communicated back to the farmer	Updates pushed automatically when a schedule shifts
Outcome	Missed windows, distress sales, spoilage	Produce ready and sold within a known, planned window

Note: this comparison describes the intended model of FarmIQ against commonly reported informal scheduling practices; it is not a measured before/after result.

G. What Farmers Need Instead

Advance notice Alerts early enough to prepare the harvest, not react to it	One clear calendar A single place to see every relevant procurement date	Multi-buyer view Government, cooperative and private schedules side by side	Reliable updates Immediate notice when a date changes or is postponed
--	--	---	---

H. How FarmlIQ Works

1

Farmer registers

Crop, location and preferred buyers/schemes are added to a farmer profile

2

Schedules aggregated

FarmlIQ tracks government mandi, cooperative and bulk-buyer procurement dates

3

Automated alerts

SMS / app notifications go out ahead of each relevant deadline

4

Farmer plans & sells

Harvest and transport are timed to a known window, not a last-minute scramble

I. Who Benefits

Farmers

- Know procurement dates well in advance
- Plan harvest and transport around real deadlines
- Avoid distress sales caused by missed windows
- Compare government, cooperative and buyer options in one view
- Reduce dependence on an agent's informal tip-off

Buyers & Procurement Agencies

- Reach registered farmers directly with schedule updates
- Reduce no-shows and last-minute rescheduling on farmers' end
- Better forecast incoming volumes for a given window
- Build a reliable, repeat channel to registered growers

J. Validation Status

Area	Status	Basis
Problem exists	Early Signal	Commonly reported issue in informal procurement tracking; no structured survey yet
Scheduling & alert model	In Development	Core automation concept defined; platform in build/pilot stage
Farmer ease of use	Needs Further Testing	Not yet field-tested with farmers
Data source coverage	Needs Further Testing	Reliable, up-to-date government and buyer schedule feeds not yet confirmed
Alert reliability	Needs Further Testing	SMS/app delivery and timing to be validated under real conditions
Income / outcome impact	Needs Further Testing	Missed-window rate and price outcomes before vs. after not yet measured

K. Final Conclusion

“Farmers don't always lose because the opportunity wasn't there — they lose because they never heard about it in time.”

FarmlIQ addresses a real and under-served gap: procurement and buyback opportunities exist, but the information about when and where they happen rarely reaches farmers early enough to act on it. By automating schedule tracking and alerts, FarmlIQ turns a reactive, word-of-mouth process into a plannable one. The next step is to prove this works reliably in the field.

Recommended next steps: (1) pilot with a first group of farmers and a defined set of mandi/buyer schedules; (2) verify accuracy and timeliness of aggregated schedule data; (3) test alert delivery (SMS/app) under real network conditions; (4) measure missed-window rate and price outcomes against manual tracking.

Methodology: This report is based on FarmlIQ's stated purpose of automating procurement schedule awareness for farmers. Problems listed are commonly reported issues with informal, manual schedule tracking, not measured figures from a survey. Findings are descriptive and should not be treated as proof of adoption or income improvement.